8-Bit Theater District: Creator Automation & AI-Agent Orchestration Tutorials

Section 1: The Long-Form Explainer (LinkedIn/Medium Style)

The Director-Engineer Workflow: How I Automated My Post-Production Pipeline in Under 6 Hours

The landscape of post-production is undergoing a fundamental transformation. Recently, I successfully built a fully automated asset ingestion and color-grading pipeline within Adobe After Effects. The most striking aspect of this project wasn't just the complexity of the final script—it was the timeframe. By leveraging Google Antigravity 2.0 and the Gemini 3 Pro reasoning model, the entire system was conceptualized, built, and refined in under six hours.

This success signals a paradigm shift: we are moving away from traditional line-by-line coding toward a **Just-in-Time (JIT) Agentic workflow**. In this model, the creator acts as a Director-Engineer, steering AI agents to build tools rather than building the tools themselves.

This workflow relies on four core pillars:

- **Contextual Scaffolding**: This involves defining the brand's visual DNA upfront within a dedicated `.md` skill file. By providing the AI with a comprehensive blueprint of the intended aesthetic, we ensure every generated script fragment adheres to a consistent stylistic logic.
- **Modular Skill Injection**: Instead of requesting a monolithic program, we inject specific "skills" into the environment. This allows the AI to focus on discrete tasks—like folder navigation or effect application—ensuring higher accuracy and easier troubleshooting.

- **Iterative Aesthetic Loops**: No creative tool is perfect in its first iteration. We progressed from Version 1, which produced a crude, bleached-out duotone, through a series of refinements to reach Version 11: a pristine, cinematic pipeline.
- **Defensive Coding**: To ensure the pipeline's reliability, we utilized a "Defensive Coding" strategy. By wrapping every operation in try/catch blocks, we eliminated silent script failures, allowing the system to log errors without crashing the entire production queue.

For more insights on the future of AI-driven development, you can explore the [Google Developers Blog.]()

Section 2: The Step-by-Step Technical Blueprint (Blog/Readme Style)

A Step-by-Step Blueprint for One-Click Asset Ingestion and Cinematic Grading

This guide outlines the technical requirements for replicating the "8-Bit Theater District" automation pipeline.

Step 1: Setting up the Command Center

The first step is establishing the environment where the AI agent operates. You must map your project folders to include an .antigravity/skills directory. This acts as the repository for the agent's instructions. Simultaneously, ensure Full Machine terminal security is established to allow the agent to interact safely with the local filesystem.

Step 2: Building the Scaffolding

Create the adobe-extendscript-automator.md skill file. This file contains the master visual DNA for the brand.

Brand Master Color Profile:

- **Neon Pink**: #FF0055
- **Cyber Cyan**: #00F0FF
- **Laser Amber**: #FFB300
- **Midnight Purple**: #1A0A2A

Step 3: Creating the Scripting Bridge

To bridge the gap between the AI-generated code and Adobe After Effects, use the `#target aftereffects` pragma at the start of your scripts. This ensures the ExtendScript engine correctly identifies the host application. Execution is handled through the native After Effects pipeline via File > Scripts > Run Script File...

Step 4: The Aesthetics of Creative Math

The core of our final `ae_import_and_grade_v11.jsx` script lies in its rendering chain math. This is how we achieved the cinematic look:

Effect	Parameter	Mathematical Logic
Levels	Black Crush	Clipping bottom luma levels by 12% to strip gray haze and increase contrast.
Tritone	10% Overlay Map	Shadows: Midnight Purple; Midtones: Cyber Cyan; Highlights: Neon Pink. Specifically tuned to protect skin tones.
Halation Glow	Targeted Bloom	Threshold: 75%, Radius: 28px, Intensity: 0.18. Creates an anamorphic light bleed strictly on primary emission sources.

For detailed documentation on After Effects scripting, refer to the [Adobe Developer Documentation].

Section 3: Social Media Micro-Content Playbook (Instagram/TikTok/YouTube Shorts)

Reel Script: From Bleached V1 to Cinematic V11

Visual Prompts:

1. **0:00-0:02**: Fast cuts of the After Effects interface with terminal windows flying by.
2. **0:02-0:05**: A split-screen showing a "V1" render (bleached out, flat) vs. "V11" (cinematic, glowing).
3. **0:05-0:10**: Screen recording of the script running, assets flying into the timeline.
4. **0:10-0:15**: Final cinematic shot from the "8-Bit Theater District" project.

Text-on-Screen:

- "Manual grading is dead."
- "V1: Bleached Duotone (6 mins in)"
- "V11: Cinematic Mastery (6 hours in)"
- "Powered by Gemini 3 Pro + Antigravity 2.0"

Voiceover Cues:
"I automated my entire After Effects pipeline in under 6 hours. We went from 'MCP Errors' and bleached-out V1 renders to a pristine, cinematic V11. Here is the secret: It's not about coding; it's about Directing the AI. Contextual scaffolding, iterative loops, and creative math. The future of post-production is here."

Ready-to-Copy Caption:
Stop coding. Start directing. 🎬 I built a one-click ingestion and cinematic grading pipeline in After Effects in under 6 hours using Google Antigravity 2.0 and Gemini 3 Pro. From raw assets to polished halation glow, it's all automated. Check the link

in bio for the full technical breakdown! #AfterEffects #Automation #CreativeTech #GeminiAI #8BitTheater

Carousel Blueprint: The Transformation Journey

- **Slide 1**: **Title Slide**. "How I Automated After Effects in 6 Hours." Large V11 cinematic shot in the background.
- **Slide 2**: **The Failure**. Showcase the V1 render. Text: "V1: The Bleached Duotone. 6 minutes in. MCP Errors everywhere. Contextual scaffolding wasn't deep enough."
- **Slide 3**: **The Shift**. Visual of the `.md` skill file. Text: "Step 1: Scaffolding. I defined the Brand DNA—Neon Pink, Cyber Cyan, Midnight Purple—before writing a single line of code."
- **Slide 4**: **The Math**. Visual of the Levels and Halation settings. Text: "The Secret Sauce: 12% Black Crush for depth and a 75% Threshold Halation for that anamorphic glow."
- **Slide 5**: **The Result**. Side-by-side comparison. Text: "V11: The Director-Engineer Workflow. One click. Perfect grades. Zero manual labor."